

Hive Migration

Databricks provides several options for migrating tables from Hive metastore to Unity Catalog. Here are the main approaches documented:

Migration Options

Databricks offers multiple migration tools depending on your specific needs:

1. **UCX (Databricks Labs)** - A comprehensive set of command-line utilities for assessing workspace readiness and performing migration of identities, permissions, storage locations, and tables. This is recommended for large-scale migrations and can upgrade to both managed and external tables [2].
2. **Unity Catalog Upgrade Wizard** - A visual interface in Catalog Explorer that enables bulk-copying of schemas and tables from Hive metastore to Unity Catalog as external tables. It can be scheduled to regularly sync changes from source Hive tables[1][2].
3. **SYNC SQL Command** - Allows copying external tables and certain managed tables from Hive metastore to external tables in Unity Catalog. You can sync individual tables or entire schemas [1][2].
4. **CREATE TABLE CLONE** - Used specifically for upgrading managed Hive tables in Delta format to managed tables in Unity Catalog [2].

Migration Requirements

Before beginning migration, you'll need:

- A workspace with Unity Catalog metastore and at least one Unity Catalog catalog
- Appropriate privileges on Unity Catalog catalogs
- Storage credentials and external locations defined in Unity Catalog
- Access to Databricks compute that supports Unity Catalog
- Proper access to tables in the Hive metastore [2]

Migration Process

The general migration process involves:

1. **Planning and preparation** - Create backups and define your governance model [4]
2. **Setting up Unity Catalog** - Enable Unity Catalog, create metastore, assign roles and permissions [4]
3. **Data migration** - Use the appropriate migration tool based on your requirements [4]
4. **Testing and validation** - Ensure data integrity after migration [4]
5. **Updating workflows and jobs** - Update existing queries to use the new tables [2]

Note that when you enable Unity Catalog, Immuta automatically migrates existing Databricks data sources to reference the legacy `hive\_metastore` catalog, but to apply Unity Catalog access controls, you'll need to move the data to Unity Catalog and re-register those tables [3].

For detailed documentation, refer to the official Databricks documentation on "Upgrade Hive tables and views to Unity Catalog."

Sources

[1] Upgrade Hive tables and views to Unity Catalog

<https://docs.databricks.com/aws/en/data-governance/unity-catalog/migrate>

[2] Upgrade Hive tables and views to Unity Catalog - Azure Databricks

<https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/azure/databricks/data-governance/unity-catalog/migrate>

[3] Migrating to Unity Catalog - Immuta Documentation - SaaS

<https://documentation.immuta.com/SaaS/configuration/integrations/databricks-unity-catalog/how-to-guide/s/migrating>

[4] Step-by-Step Migration from Databricks Hive Metastore to Unity ...

<https://www.crawlspider.com/step-by-step-migration-from-databricks-hive-metastore-to-unity-catalog/>